

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written on four staves in G-flat major (two flats) and 2/2 time. The melody is simple and repetitive, with a mix of quarter and eighth notes. Chord symbols (Eb, Bb, Ab, E, D.C.) are placed above the staff to indicate the harmonic structure. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated. The score ends with a double bar line and a repeat sign.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...